

Course Syllabus: Professional Ethics in Information Technology 1st Semester, A.Y. 2026–2027

Course Information

Instructor: [Ethics Instructor Name] | Units: 3 | Schedule: MWF 11:00 AM–12:00 NN | Room: Room 301

1. Course Description

This course examines the ethical, legal, and social dimensions of information technology. Topics include professional codes of conduct, intellectual property rights, data privacy and protection laws (including the Philippine Data Privacy Act of 2012), cybercrime legislation (RA 10175), social media ethics, algorithmic bias, AI ethics, digital divide, and responsible technology development. Students will analyze real-world case studies and develop frameworks for ethical decision-making in the IT profession.

2. Learning Outcomes

- LO 1: Analyze ethical dilemmas in technology using established ethical frameworks such as utilitarianism, deontology, and virtue ethics.
- LO 2: Apply Philippine laws on data privacy, cybercrime, and intellectual property to real-world IT scenarios.
- LO 3: Evaluate the social impact of emerging technologies including artificial intelligence, surveillance systems, and social media platforms.
- LO 4: Formulate an ethical decision-making framework applicable to professional IT practice.

3. Weekly Schedule

Week	Topic	Assessment
1	Introduction to Ethics; IT Profession and Ethical Responsibility	Quiz 1
2	Ethical Frameworks: Utilitarianism, Deontology, Virtue Ethics	Case Study 1
3	Professional Codes of Conduct: ACM, IEEE, DICT Guidelines	Quizzes
4	Intellectual Property Rights; Copyright, Patents, and Licenses	IP Analysis Paper
5	Philippine Data Privacy Act (RA 10173); NPC Regulations	Case Study 2
6	GDPR Overview; Cross-border Data Transfers and Compliance	Quiz 2
7	Cybercrime Prevention Act (RA 10175); Legal Cases in IT	IT Case Analysis
8	Midterm Examination	Midterm Exam
9	Social Media Ethics; Fake News; Online Harassment Laws	Final: Ethics Position Paper

10	Algorithmic Bias; Fairness in AI Systems	Case Study 3
11	AI Ethics Frameworks; UNESCO Recommendation on AI	Discussion Forum
12	Digital Divide; Accessibility and Inclusion in Technology	PT 3: Policy Proposal
13	Whistleblowing in IT; Corporate Responsibility	Quiz 4
14	Emerging Issues: Deepfakes, Surveillance Capitalism, Biometrics	Panel Discussion
15	Student Presentations: Ethical Case Study Analysis	Group Presentation
16	Final Examination	Final Exam

4. Grading System

Component	Weight
Quizzes	15%
Case Studies and Discussion	20%
Performance Tasks	25%
Midterm Exam	20%
Final Exam	20%

5. Course Policies

Class Discussion: Ethical discussions require respect and open-mindedness. Students must listen actively and engage thoughtfully. Personal attacks or discriminatory language will not be tolerated.

Position Papers: Must be submitted in APA format, minimum 3 pages, with at least 5 credible references. AI-generated papers without proper disclosure and critical analysis will not be accepted.

Case Studies: Group case study presentations must include a clear identification of the ethical issue, applicable laws, stakeholder analysis, and a recommended course of action.

6. Key Laws and References

1. Republic Act 10173 — Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Philippines).
2. Republic Act 10175 — Cybercrime Prevention Act of 2012 (Philippines).
3. Republic Act 8792 — Electronic Commerce Act of 2000 (Philippines).
4. UNESCO Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021).
5. ACM Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct (2018).
6. Tavani, H. (2016). Ethics and Technology: Controversies, Questions, and Strategies for Ethical Computing. Wiley.